

SCALING SAFe & TEAM TOPOLOGIES

Evolution from 9 to 17 ARTs

24 March 2026

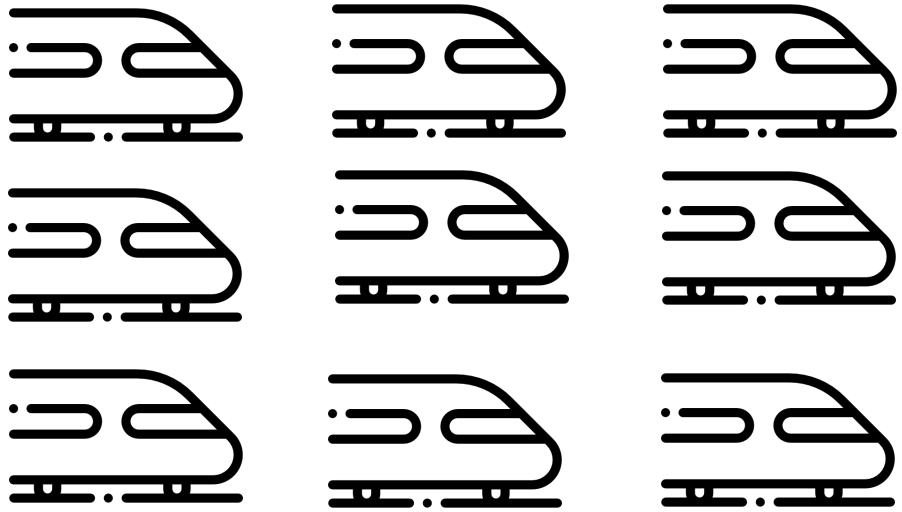
SAFe Summit Amsterdam



HOW DO YOU THINK AN ORGANIZATION GOES FROM ZERO



... TO 9 AGILE RELEASE TRAINS ?



9

1

Reading from the stars ?

2

Going for a 12 months pilote ?

3

Straight to Big Bang ?

WHO WE ARE



Angélique SEVAUX

Head of Bpifrance LACE
& RTE on ART « Collab X »



Marta Thongsavarn

Enterprise Lean-Agile Coach |
Driving Business Agility with SAFe,
LPM, OKRs & Gen AI |

BPIFRANCE: SOLUTIONS FOR ALL COMPANIES



100 YEARS OF PUBLIC BANKING IN FRANCE

Bpifrance supports structures of all sizes, primarily very small businesses (VSE), small and mid-sized enterprises (SMEs), as well as larger companies (LC) they play a strategic role in the national economy, regional development, or employment.

TPE

FINANCING COMPANIES' INVESTMENT AND CASH-FLOW NEEDS

- Amorçage
- Seed funding
- Innovative support
- Guarantee
- Financing

SME

SUPPORTING THE GROWTH OF SMEs ACROSS FRANCE AND BORDERS

- Innovative support
- Guarantee
- Financing
- International support and export
- financing
- Export insurance
- Support : consulting, training and
- networking
- Growth capital
- Succession capital

ETI

STRENGTHENING MID-CAPS IN THEIR DEVELOPMENT AND INTERNATIONALISATION

- Aid for innovation
- Funding
- International support and export financing
- Export Insurance
- Support: consulting, university and networking
- Growth capital
- Capital transmission

GE

CONTRIBUTING TO THE INFLUENCE OF LARGE COMPANIES

- Collaborative innovative programs
- Financing
- Export insurance
- Capital stabilization

50

LOCATIONS
REGIONAL

PROXIMITY

• SIMPLICITY

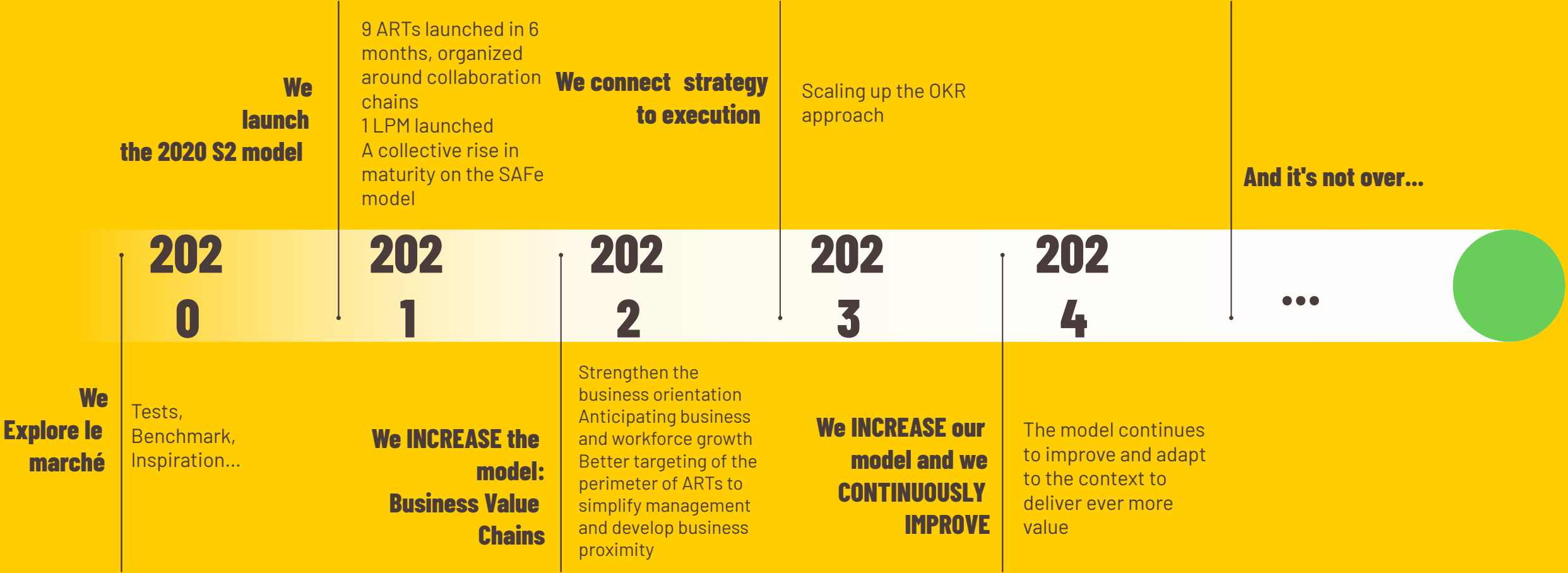
• AMBITION

• OPTIMISM

bpifrance | 4



A BRIEF HISTORY OF BPIFRANCE'S LEAN-AGILE TRANSFORMATION



WHY DID WE CHOSE

SAFe

SAFe® 6 for Lean Business is a knowledge base of proven and integrated principles, practices, and skills to achieve business agility by implementing Lean, Agile, and DevOps at scale

<https://scaledagileframework.com/>

SAFe's business benefits are derived directly from case studies written by SAFe customers.



<https://scaledagile.com/insights-customer-stories/>

2011

Field experience at enterprise scale



Lean product development | Agile development | DevOps | Systems thinking

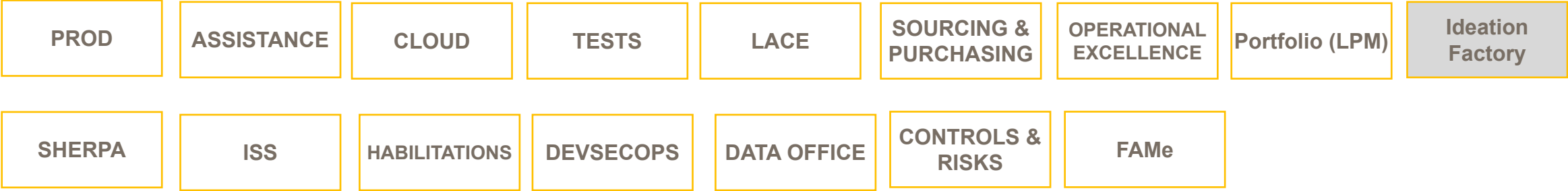
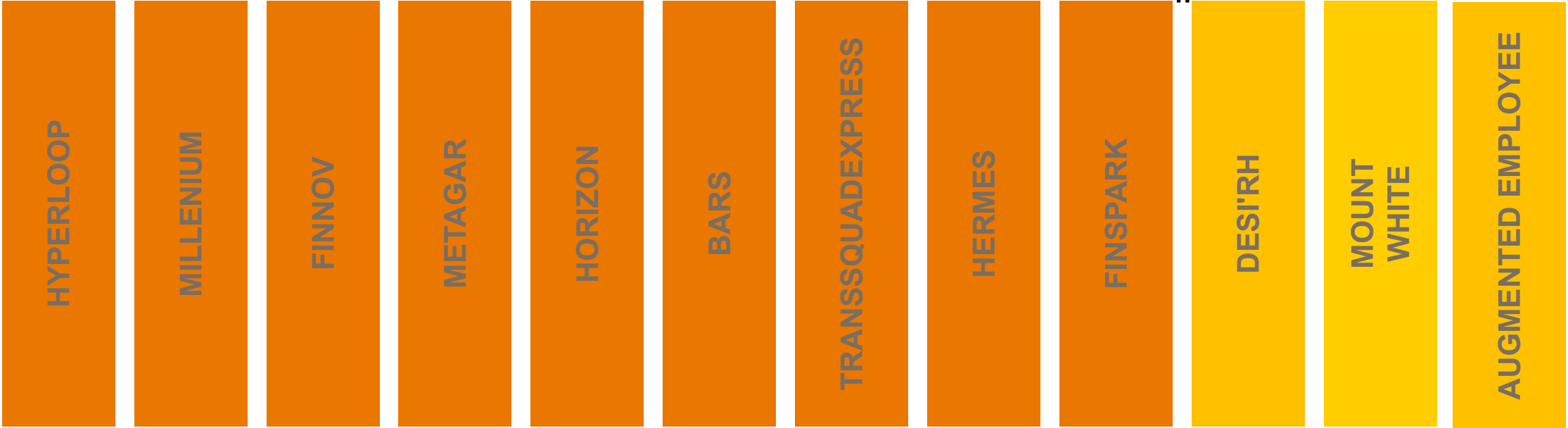
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HOW IT STARTED

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TRAINS

TRAMWAYS



SHARED SERVICES



WHY BPIFRANCE IS TRULY UNIQUE



CEO + CIO Sponsorship

Nicolas Dufourcq (CEO) vision + Lionel Chaîne (CIO) conviction. Not just an IT project — a full business transformation with 28 business lines.



Stay Close to the Standard

Use a real framework (SAFe) with few customisations. No complex variations — this is one reason the transformation moved fast.



All SAFe Skills in Parallel

Org Agility, LPM, Team & Technical Agility, Continuous Learning — all launched together to create momentum.



Remarkable Investment in People

Training, learning, coaching — for everyone. IT and business. A real belief in long-term change.



Test & Learn — Fail Fast

Experiment fast, fail fast. Bpifrance even celebrates failures. People test, learn, and adjust quickly — together.



Internal LACE

External experts for a quick boost, then internal skills built for sustainability. Business-IT Fusion Teams — working as one.



YEARS LATER...

Agility was deployed at scale. The numbers were impressive.

250

Agile Teams

300+

Portfolio Initiatives

28

Business Departments

€230M

Digital Portfolio



AGILITY DEPLOYED AT SCALE

VELOCITY

DATA MATURITY

QOS

NEW AMBITIONS
BUSINESS

TRANSVERSE





THE TURNING POINT – STRUCTURE BECOMES THE PROBLEM

After 5 years of Agile at scale, we reached a pivotal moment

Agility was no longer the problem. The real challenge was structure.



Cognitive load increases

Teams growing overloaded — beyond human-scale limits. Clarity and trust start to erode.



Decision-making slows

Coordination costs explode. Instead of accelerating value, the org starts protecting itself from complexity.



Flow cost rises

Scale creates friction: coordination grows faster than delivery. Flow is being taxed.

That's when we made a clear decision: we needed to redesign the organisation itself. Value streams identification and Team Topologies became our compass.



TAKE AWAY When scale creates friction faster than it creates value — the structure itself must evolve. Maintain your agility by upgrading the system.

IDENTIFICATION OF VALUE CHAINS



01

Entrepreneur ayant besoin de financer et/ou assurer son projet et de se faire accompagner



02

Organisme financier qui a besoin d'une garantie



03

Bailleur de fonds qui a besoin de suivre ses fonds

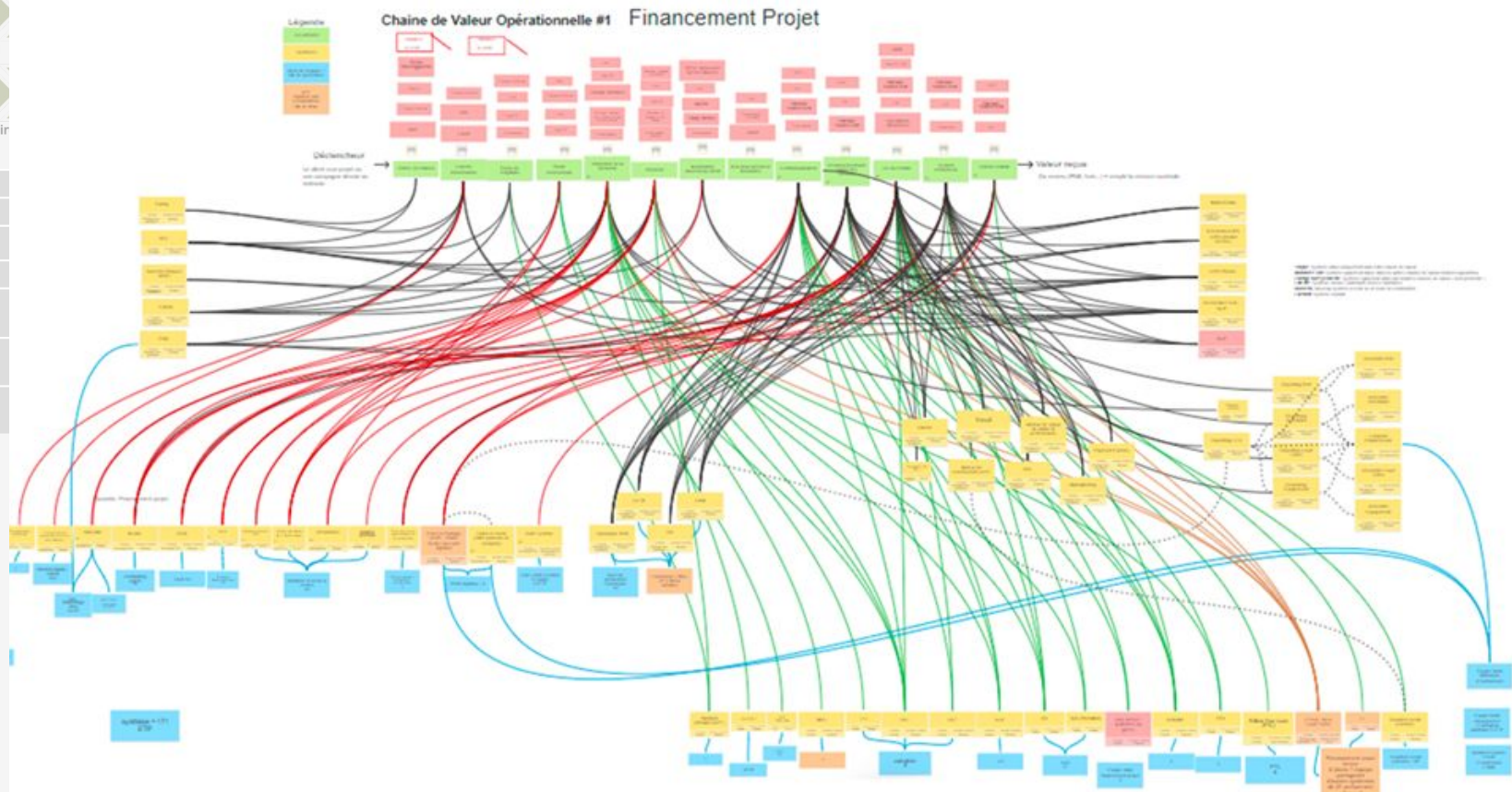


04

Régulateur à qui on doit démontrer que les aides sont licites et légales et que les processus sont respectés

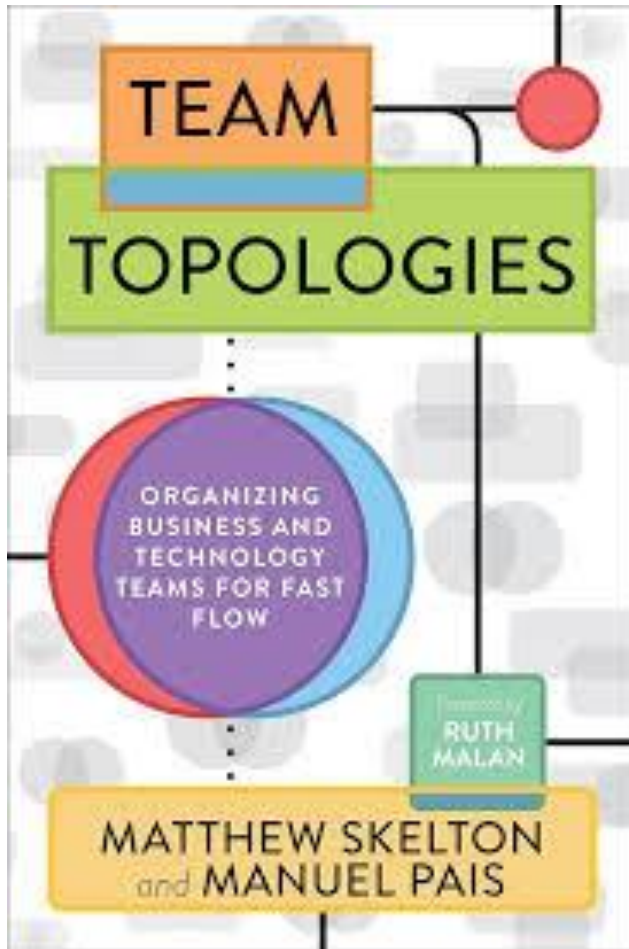


Type	Chaîne de Valeur Opérationnelle de Traitement
Nom	Financement Projet
Description	Entrepreneur ayant besoin de financer et/ou assurer son projet et de se faire accompagner
Client(s)	Entrepreneur ou groupement d'entrepreneur
Déclencheurs	Le client a un projet ou une campagne directe ou indirecte
Valeur reçue pour l'entreprise	Du revenu (PNB, frais...) + remplir la mission sociétale
Valeur reçue par le client	Argent + expertise pour concrétiser son projet

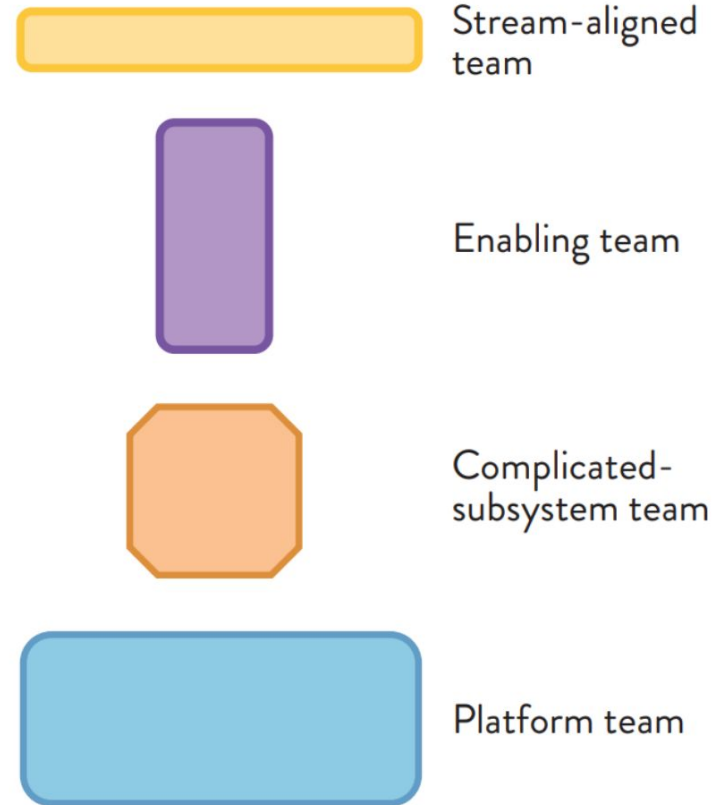




APPLYING TEAM TOPOLOGIES

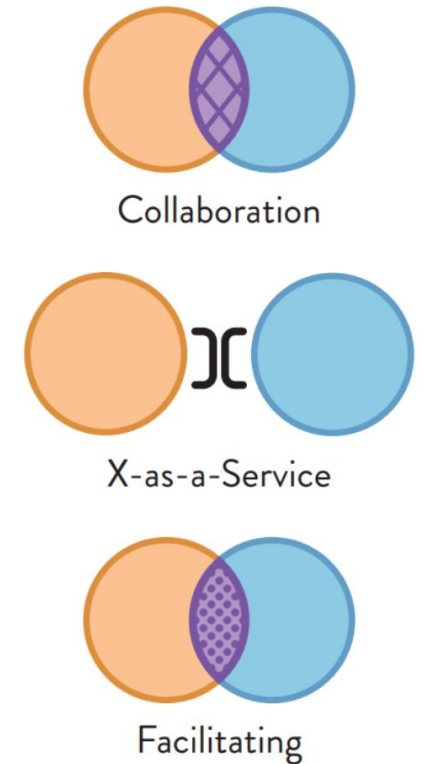


Four Team Types



© Matthew Skelton and Manuel Pais from *Team Topologies*

Three Interaction Modes





GUIDELINES FOR ARTS RECONFIGURATION



ARTs aligned with
business challenges

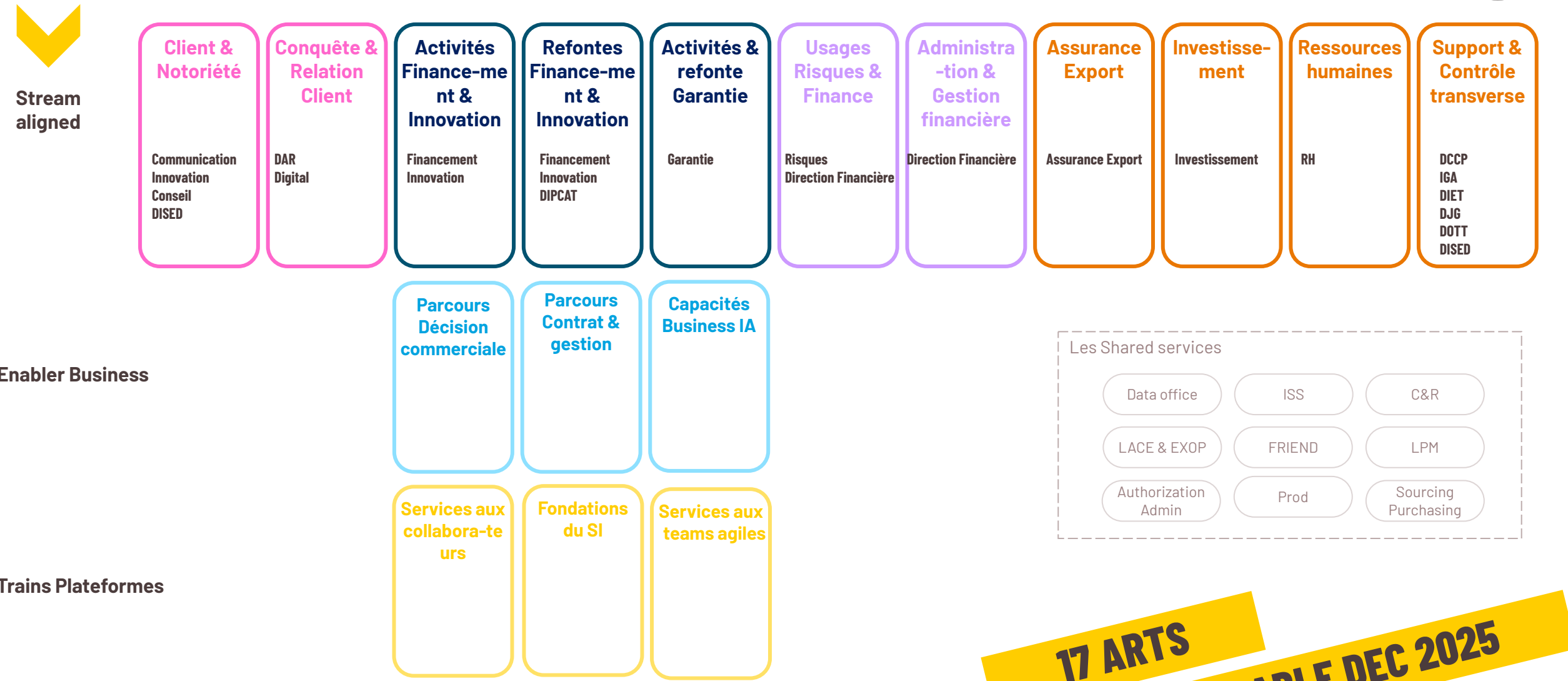


Smaller ARTs to
better control our
Exop and the **QOS**



Better **dependency**
management

THE NEW ARTS & EXEMPLE OF BUSINESS LINES



17 ARTS

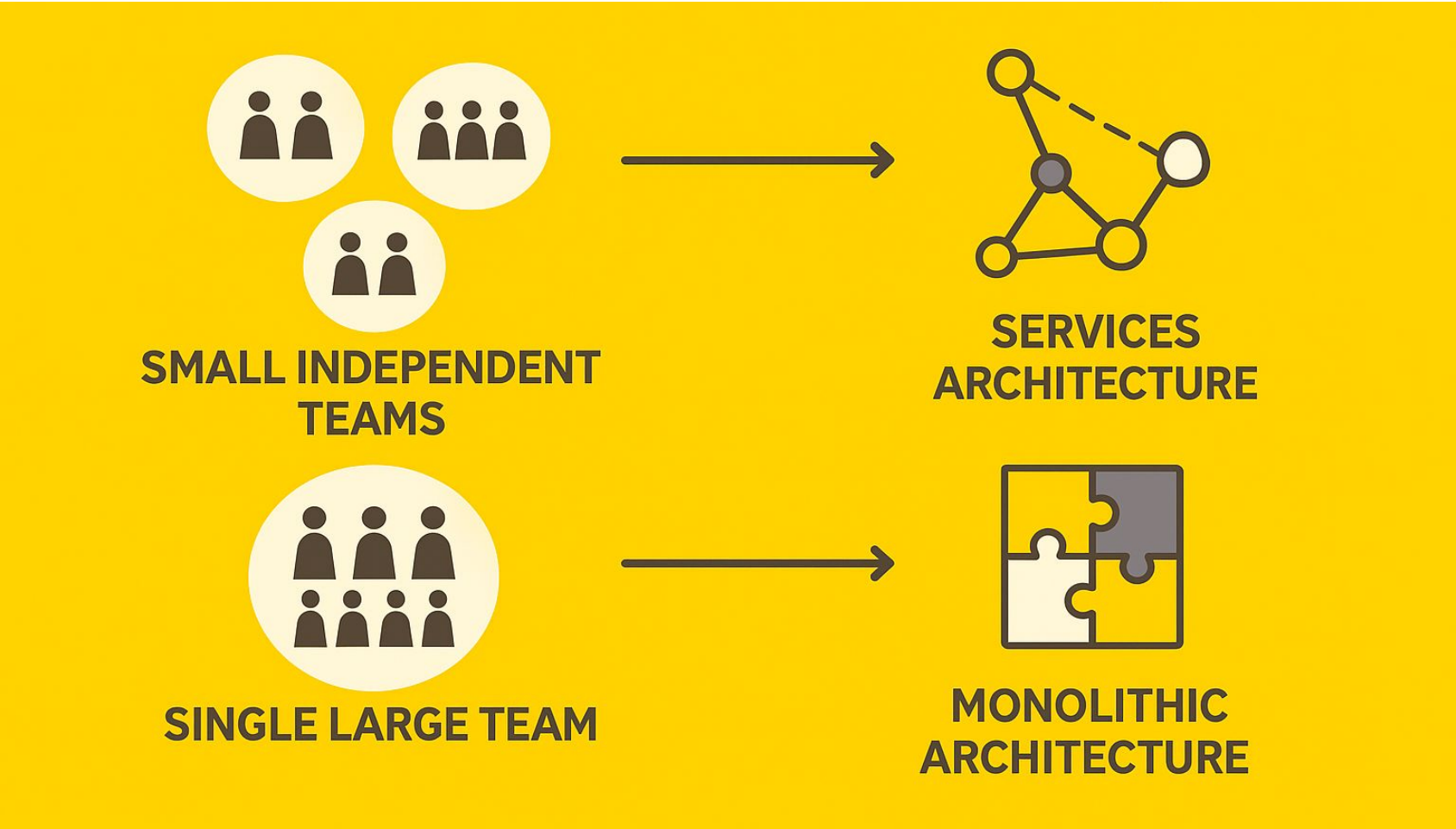
APPLICABLE DEC 2025



THE NEW ARTS & EXEMPLE OF BUSINESS LINES

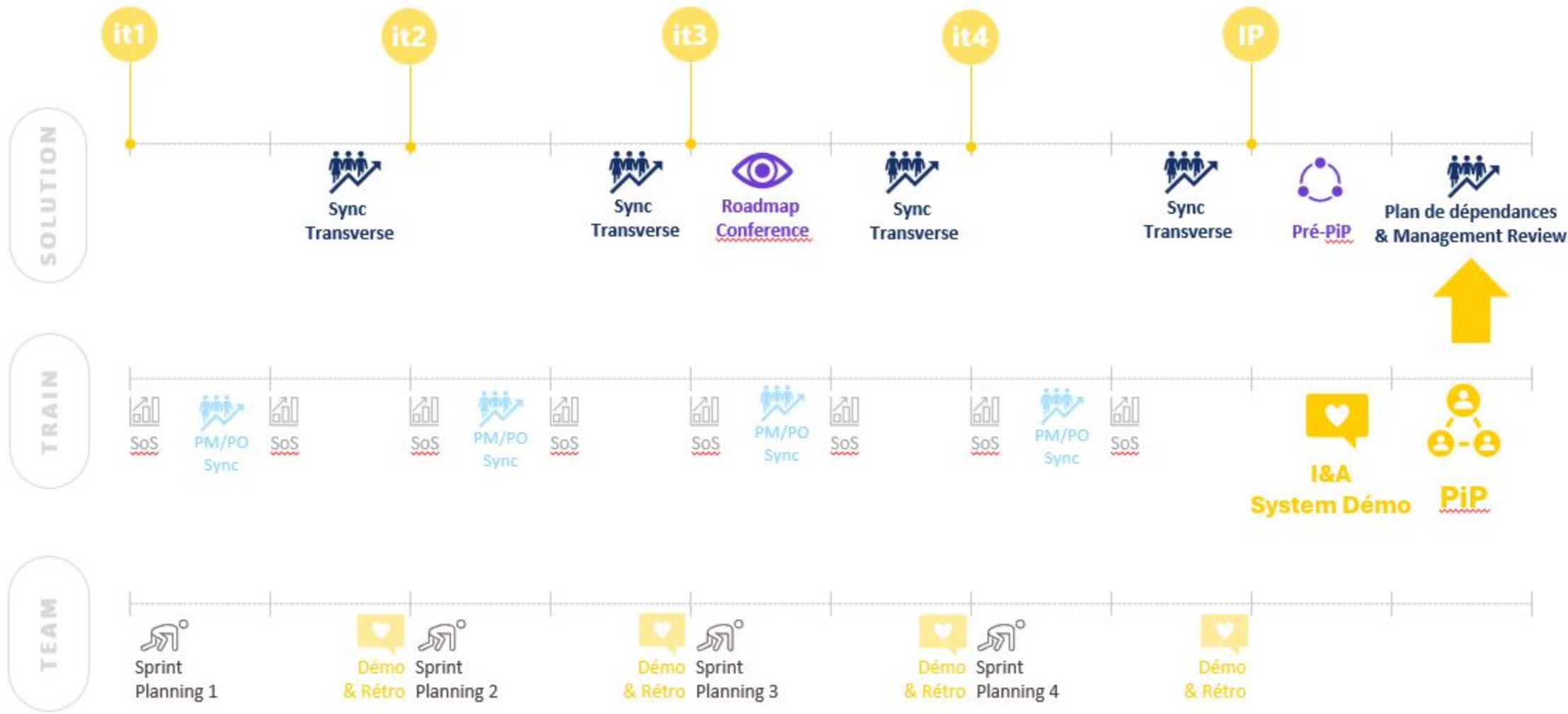
Organisation

Software





THE CUSTOMIZED CEREMONIES



PIP TIMING

- All ARTs **are synchronized over the same fortnights**,
- **Platform** ARTs are 1 iteration ahead
- ARTs **with a high dependency are in PIP at the same time**

IP Platform					IP enabling & Stream aligned				
Semaine 1					Semaine 2				
L	Ma	Me	J	V	L	Ma	Me	J	V
I&A					PIP 1				

Semaine 1					Semaine 2				
L	Ma	Me	J	V	L	Ma	Me	J	V
I&A					PIP 2				

Semaine 1					Semaine 2				
L	Ma	Me	J	V	L	Ma	Me	J	V
I&A					PIP 3				

Semaine 1					Semaine 2				
L	Ma	Me	J	V	L	Ma	Me	J	V
I&A					PIP 4				

- **The inspect and adapt of each ART is based** on the days available, considering that a ARR that is in PIP in one week is in I&A in the other week.

Dates 25-ECHO :

Group 1 :

November 24 to 27

1. Services for agile teams
2. IS Foundations

November 28

1. Employee Services

Group 2 : December 4 & 5:

1. Customer & Reputation
2. Conquest & Customer Relationship
3. Export insurance

Group 3 : 8 & 9 December:

1. Activities Financing & Innovation
2. Financing & Innovation Redesigns
3. Guaranteed activities and redesigns
4. Business AI capabilities
5. Instruction course
6. Contract & Management Pathway

Group 4 : December 10 & 11:

1. Uses, Risks & Finance
2. Administration & Financial Management
3. Human Resources
4. Compliance & Legal
5. Investment (Haussmann)

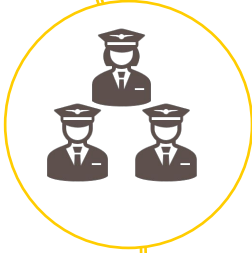




THE BENEFITS OBTAINED



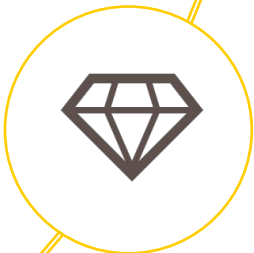
Sharper Value Alignment & Stronger Business Focus



Better Dependency Management & Faster Flow

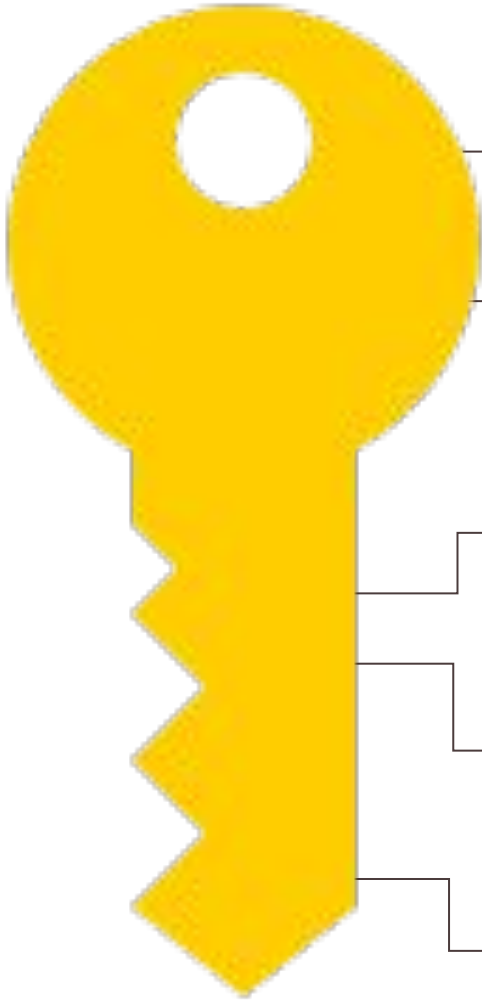


Reduction of Cognitive Load & Higher Team Performance



Stronger Structural Agility & Long-Term Scalability

THE KEYS TO SUCCESS



START WITH WHY, CLARITY AND PURPOSE

BUILD AROUND PEOPLE, NOT PROCESSES

SYNCHRONISE THE SYSTEM TO SYNCHRONISE THE MINDS

KEEP WHAT WORKS. REINVENT WHAT DOESN'T

NEVER STOP IMPROVING

LESSONS LEARNED

What worked · What didn't · What we'd do differently

✓ What Worked

Clear boundaries & aligned responsibilities — explicit value-stream & ART boundaries

Role definitions (RTE, PM, PO) helped synchronize priorities across iterations

Fixed SAFe cadence created predictability & strengthened cross-team collaboration

Strong CEO/CIO sponsorship accelerated adoption & removed blockers quickly

✗ What Didn't Work

Role overload & multi-hatting — Scrum Master + PO, Architect + Developer simultaneously

Lack of dedicated time for responsibilities → inconsistent ceremonies & unbalanced workloads

SAFe added ceremony overhead without immediate value for smaller/newer teams

Dependency management between ARTs remained a challenge, causing delays

↻ Do Differently

Introduce flow metrics (Flow Time, Flow Load, Flow Efficiency) from the very beginning

Define KPIs aligned with value delivery — not activity tracking

Ensure key SAFe roles are fully staffed with dedicated agile coaching from day one

Reduce multi-hatting — dedicate time to product management, architecture, and facilitation



MERC

I